Indoor/Outdoor

By Kenny Finkle

NOTE: This cutting asks one student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

SAMANTHA: **(Pg 1)** *(Lights up on SAMANTHA by herself) (To audience)* Hi. My name's Samantha *(Just then SHUMAN appears on stage, looking for SAMANTHA.)*

SHUMAN: Samantha? SAMANTHA?? *(He wanders off.)*

SAMANTHA: That's Shuman. I live with him. He's looking for me right now. We'll get to him in a minute. First though, you need to know me. I suppose this is as good a time as any to tell you . . . I'm a cat.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR: *As is true with most cats, Samantha didn't have an easy childhood.*
ACTRESS: *She was ripped away from her mother as soon as she was old enough to eat real food and dropped at the animal shelter. (Thunder clap and or ominous music)*
ACTOR: *Don't they kill cats at the Animal Shelter. (Thunder clap and or ominous music)*
ACTRESS: *You get five days. Five days to find your "forever home". And then . . . . Well, let's not think about that.*
ACTOR: *How in the world do you do that when you are 1 of a gazillion stray cats?*
TOGETHER: *Indoor/Outdoor by Kenny Finkle*

SAMANTHA: **(Pg 4)** *(To audience)* The Animal Shelter was totally horrible. Think *Amistad* meets *Schindler's List*. I wanted to find true love. But I didn't know how to go about it. How do you find your true love? Especially in an animal shelter where you only have five days to do it. **(Pg 6-8)** And it was at that exact moment that Shuman fell into my life. *(SHUMAN enters.)* From across the crowded shelter our eyes met. *(He sees SAMANTHA. They look at each*

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other.) BAM! A connection! It knocked us both off our feet! *(They both fall backwards.)* Then, he got up, walked to my cage, and a second later I was in his arms. He was so warm and strong. And then he put his hand under my chin and started scratching and I, for the first time in my life, started to purr.

SHUMAN: You're purring. Are you happy?

SAMANTHA: Yes very. *(To audience)* And if I didn't know then that he was my true love. What he said next sealed the deal.

SHUMAN: Hi. I guess you're coming home with me. You're beautiful. Your name is . . . *(He looks deeply into her eyes)* Samantha.

SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* Shuman named me.

SHUMAN: You don't have to be scared anymore, I'll love you like you are supposed to be loved until the day I die.

SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* And Shuman took me to his home. And became my true love. And it was everything I dreamed it would be. For a while at least . . . **(Pg 10-13)** Before we go any further, I think that this may be a good time to tell you more [about] Shuman, the man. *(We are now in SHUMAN's office; he is working at his computer)* Shuman works from home, doing web design. In case you didn't notice, Shuman is very sensitive and cries over almost anything.

SHUMAN: Save. Save! SAVE! SAVE!!!! Why won't you save? I, I, I, I- *(He starts crying hysterically).*

SAMANTHA: Every morning Shuman gets up and talks to himself in the mirror.

SHUMAN: I am worthy of success. I am worthy of love. I am worthy of hope. I am worthy of dreams. I am worthy of Samantha. I am worthy of this day. Good morning.

SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* One of Shuman's favorite things to do is put on music really

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loud and sing and dance to it. Sometimes he even lets me dance with him.

SHUMAN: Everybody dance! *(SHUMAN scoops up SAMANTHA and sings and dances to Madness' song Our House.)* Our house in the middle of our street. Our house in the middle of our ... Our house ... *(To Samantha)* Oh Sammy! You are the greatest thing that's ever happened to me!

SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* And it was at this exact moment that I noticed Shuman had a crumb of food on his upper lip. Shuman noticed me staring at him and he said-

SHUMAN: You're trying to look into my soul aren't you?

SAMANTHA: No . . . I'm not. You have a crumb on your lip and its driving me crazy! *(To audience)* And for the first time I realized that maybe Shuman didn't always understand me. Just as clarification, I think I should say I speak in Cat. This is what I really sound like. ***Meow wowo, memeo, meowwww.*** So I suppose it shouldn't be all that surprising but still, sometimes he'd be so far off the mark it'd be shocking! **(Pg 23-24)** [Case in point . . .] one night, I heard a rustling in the kitchen and I had to see what it was. I ran into the kitchen and found a mouse rifling through the cabinets. *(A MOUSE appears)*

MOUSE: Oh sh**, a cat.

SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* No one had ever told me about mice before, but somehow I instinctively knew that mice were evil and that I was to rid the house of them. So that's what I attempted to do. All night long. *(SAMANTHA chases the MOUSE)* Finally, I got the mouse under my paw.

MOUSE: Ow.

SAMANTHA: Shut up. *(To audience)* And I started toying with it. Like so. *(To MOUSE)* Should I let you go?

MOUSE: Yes, please, I didn't mean to be here anyway, I must have taken a wrong turn in Albuquerque-

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SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* For those of you that are weak of heart, I'll refrain from illustrating the rest of what happened. For those of you that aren't weak of heart, think *Texas Chainsaw Massacre* meets *Nightmare on Elm Street*! However, suffice it to say, eventually I killed it. . . Killing. Chasing. Using my instincts like that. It came so naturally. And it felt so good! I felt like a wild tigress! And I never wanted to feel any different! The whole next day I carried the mouse around in my mouth. I started to walk with more confidence. *(Confident SAMANTHA shows us her more confident walk. Shuman notices she has a mouse in her mouth and tries to take it from her)*

SHUMAN: **(Pg 25-29)** Oh, Sammy, let go. Ew. Oh my god. Ew. Ew. Ew. This is so . . . disgusting.The mouse has to be thrown away.

SAMANTHA: No! The mouse is mine. I killed it. You can't just throw it away. Its mine! MINE! *(SHUMAN picks SAMANTHA up. She flails.)* No! SHUMAN GET OFF ME! THE MOUSE IS MINE! GIVE ME BACK MY MOUSE! *(To audience)* But he didn't listen to me and he threw the mouse away. After that I snuck out of bed every night and roamed the house looking for danger or excitement or both. And then one night, while stalking through the kitchen, the very thing I'd been looking for found me. And his name was Oscar the cat. *(OSCAR the Cat appears. He is one cool cat.)* I first spotted him through the sliding glass door. I was frozen to the spot. I couldn't move. I couldn't breathe.

OSCAR: Hey ... sup sweetheart? I'm Oscar. I'm an alley cat. Moved up here from the city a few years back. You're cool. Do you like living inside? I've never done it. Can't imagine what it's like. Outside is the only place I've ever lived. Born and bred. If you ever got out here, I'd show you all these cool places. Like there's a little garden just down the road. In the afternoon I lay out there and get sun. Have you ever felt sun on your coat? It's heaven.

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SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* And I started to wonder why hadn't Shuman ever taken me outside? Why was I an indoor cat?

OSCAR: You know where I wish I could take you? The beach. Do you know its only sand and water? Just water and sand. It's like a giant litter box. And sand, oh man, sand is supposed to feel like heaven underneath your paws. Sure during the day people are around but at night, it'd be ours.

SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* Ours. He said ours. I'd never thought of there being another "ours" besides me and Shuman and then there was Oscar saying "ours" and I couldn't help but think that it sounded right. Like I was really supposed to be with Oscar outside and not with Shuman inside. But I loved Shuman. Or maybe I didn't. I didn't know anymore.

SAMANTHA: *(awkwardly flirting)* **(Pg 34-39)** My name's Samantha . . . I killed a mouse once.

OSCAR: Samantha. Sa-man-tha. I like that. You're a beast! You're a goddess! You're a tigress! You're-you're so unbelievable! *(Suddenly SHUMAN enters the kitchen and flips on a light.)*

SHUMAN: Samantha? Who's this? What's going on? Where'd she come from? You two friends? That's so sweet. Come on, let's go to bed

SAMANTHA: No. I'm not going to bed with you Shuman. I want to stay here. I want to stay with Oscar!

SHUMAN: You want me to pick you up? *(SHUMAN picks SAMANTHA up in his arms.)*

SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* And I was so angry at him for picking me up and disturbing me and Oscar that I-well I did something I'd never done before. *(SAMANTHA bites SHUMAN' s arm.)*

SHUMAN: OW!!!! GOD DAMN IT!!!!!! OW!!!!! *(SAMANTH, hissing, jumps out of SHUMAN's arms.)* I can't believe you bit me! Bad girl! Bad BAD GIRL! You will not be allowed in bed tonight! You can stay out here and think about

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what you did! *(SHUMAN exits. SAMANTHA turns to OSCAR.)*

SAMANTHA: So, where were we?

OSCAR: Look, save your breath. I'm an alley cat, OK? I know how this goes. So I'm just gonna back away now. Real slow. And then it'll be like I wasn't ever here and it'll all be cool. *(He starts to leave.)*

SAMANTHA: No! Oscar! I want to bust out of here. I'm going to figure something out. I promise. *(To audience).* Maybe if I started to act wild around the house, Shuman would get the idea and let me out. So I started doing these really complex and bizarre running patterns all around the living room. *(SAMANTHA does a bizarre running pattern. SHUMAN follows, talking as he runs.)*

SHUMAN: Sammy? Sammy! Stop! Hey!

SAMANTHA: I then proceeded to destroy everything I possibly could. *(As she continues to run, SAMANTHA starts knocking off plants, books, anything in her way. SHUMAN attempts to pick up the pieces behind her.)*

SHUMAN: Stop it Sammy! No! That's expensive! Whay are you doing this? OK. OK. You win. Just go ahead. I need to sit. I need to sit and . . . breathe. *(He sits and breathes to calm himself – he may even be crying a little)*

SAMANTHA: [But] I knew I had to take things further if I wanted Shuman to kick me out. Finally one morning while in my litter box, it hit me. If you catch my drift… I decided that the best place to do it would be on his computer. After all he spent so much time there and if I really did it right, he would possibly have to get a whole new computer. Soon enough, Shuman discovered it. *(SHUMAN enters and sees the computer.)*

SHUMAN: No. Ew. SAMMY!!!!!???

SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* I went right up to him and stared at him with a look of defiance. *(SHUMAN picks up SAMMY roughly by the scruff of the neck)*

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SHUMAN: I've had it with you. Do you hear me? You've destroyed everything in this house! I'm throwing you out. Out into the forest so you can get attacked and killed and eaten by wild animals. *(He sets her down to open the door)* So, goodbye! And don't come back asking for food. Because I'm not giving you any. *(He starts to open the door)*

SAMANTHA: *(To audience)* [I was] so close. And then . . .

SHUMAN: *(Stops, takes a breath to calm himself and turns to audience)* **(Pg 45)** She's a cat! She's supposed to be simple. That's why I got a cat! I wanted simple. I'm good at simple. I'm not good at the other stuff. *(sadly to SAMANTHA)* **(Pg 49)** No matter what I do you're not happy.

SAMANTHA: *(Still angry)* You never listen to me.

SHUMAN: **(Pg 51-53)** [But] I feel like I know you. *(all of a sudden, Shuman can actually hear what Samantha is saying, and a look of amazement passes over his face)*

SAMANTHA: If you did, you wouldn't have thrown my mouse away.

SHUMAN: Your mouse?

SAMANTHA: Yes my mouse! I killed that!

SHUMAN: I know you killed it. It was going to start smelling so I threw it away. It was dead!

SAMANTHA: I loved that I killed that mouse and if you knew me at all you would have known that. *(to audience)* He thinks I'm simple! *(yelling at SHERMAN)* I'm not simple! I'm complicated. *(Shuman starts to cry, but SAMANTHA is resolute)* Your crying isn't real. You're a fake. You have no backbone. You are a miserable lonely person. Let me leave!

SHUMAN: **(Pg 60-61)** *(SHERMAN opens the door slowly)* Samantha, if you want to go. . Go. I can't keep you. I don't want to fight anymore. *(Samantha and Shuman stare at each other.)* I just wish I were enough for you. But if I can't be, then I can't. *(Samantha begins to leave, but then hesitates)*

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SAMANTHA: **(pg 68-69)** *(to audience)* And I realized in that moment that by letting me outside, Shuman had told me that he loved me unconditionally. And I knew then that this was my home. *(Meows loudly)* And I looked Shuman right in the eyes and I said: Sometimes you won't get me and sometimes I won't get you, but I'll love you. And for a second I wasn't sure if he understood, but I ***was*** home. And it was enough. **(Pg 71)** And soon after that Shuman installed a new front door that had a flap in it, so I could come and go as I please. *(She goes through the door)* Yeah, I'm outside! *(She goes back though the door)* Yeah, I'm inside! . . . . **(Pg 76)** Maybe life is just this. Just this. This brief moment we have together where we're inside each other and outside ourselves and we can all just let go.

SHUMAN: Oh, Samantha. I love you.

SAMANTHA: Meow!

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Kenny Finkle
ISBN: 978-0881453300
Publisher: Broadway Play Publishing
Date (Month/Year): 2006

AWARD HISTORY

2016 National Qualifier
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Our House – Lyrics and Music can be found at
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BnG8OI50BEk

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